



Introduction to Contesting

- Radiosport -

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What is Radio Contesting?

According to the ARRL, radio contesting (or radiosport) is a competitive activity where amateur radio operators and stations try to contact as many other stations as possible within a specific time period.

Who can participate?

Anyone with a valid amateur radio license:

- License in good standing and not expired
- Issued by the FCC in the USA
- Equivalent to FCC from another DXCC entity



V4 / AC6ZM



VP2MMA



IT9 / AC6ZM

What Contest to Enter?

PERIODIC TABLE OF SELECT AMATEUR RADIO CONTESTS																							
Start Day (UTC) → 1		2 → End Day (UTC)		https://Radiosport.World/										off-the-air		SSB		VHF/UHF					
Start Time (UTC) → 0000Z		2359Z → End Time (UTC)		2024										Multimode		CW		Digital					
Contest Name		Select Contest of weekend as chosen by N3QE																					
Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec												
6 1800Z	7 2359Z	4 0000Z	4 0359Z	2 0000Z	3 2359Z	6 1500Z	7 1500Z	4 varies	5 varies	1 1800Z	2 2400Z	6 1400Z	7 1400Z	3 1800Z	4 0600Z	8 0000Z	8 0400Z	5 1600Z	6 2159Z	2 2100Z	4 0300Z	6 2200Z	8 1600Z
ARRL RTTY Roundup	NA Sprint CW	ARRL DX SSB	SP Polish DX	7QRP/IN/DE New England QSO Parties	ARRL Digital	Marconi Memorial HF	NAQP CW	NA Sprint CW	California QSO Party	ARRL SS CW	ARRL 160												
13 1800Z	14 0559Z	10 0000Z	11 2359Z	10 0000Z	10 0359Z	13 0700Z	14 1300Z	11 1200Z	12 1200Z	8 1800Z	10 0300Z	13 1200Z	14 1200Z	10 0000Z	11 2359Z	14 0000Z	15 2359Z	12 0600Z	13 0600Z	9 0000Z	10 2359Z	14 0000Z	15 2359Z
NAQP CW	CQ WPX RTTY	NA Sprint RTTY	JIDX CW	Volta WW RTTY	ARRL June VHF	IARU HF	WAE CW	WAE SSB	Oceania CW	WAE RTTY	ARRL 10												
20 1800Z	21 0559Z	17 0000Z	18 2359Z	16 0200Z	18 0200Z	20 0700Z	21 0659Z	16 1100Z	19 2000Z	15 0000Z	16 2400Z	20 1800Z	21 0559Z	17 1800Z	18 0600Z	14 1800Z	16 0300Z	19 1500Z	20 1459Z	16 2100Z	18 0300Z	21 1400Z	22 1400Z
NAQP SSB	ARRL DX CW	BARTG HF RTTY	CQMM DX	Contest University Dayton Hamvention	All Asian DX CW	NAQP RTTY	NAQP SSB	ARRL September VHF	Worked All Germany	ARRL SS SSB	Croatian DX												
26 2200Z	28 2200Z	24 1800Z	25 0559Z	24 0000Z	24 0400Z	27 1600Z	28 2159Z	25 0000Z	26 2400Z	22 1800Z	23 2100Z	27 1200Z	28 1200Z	24 1200Z	25 1200Z	21 1200Z	22 1200Z	26 0000Z	27 2400Z	23 0000Z	24 2400Z	28 0000Z	28 2359Z
CQ 160 CW	NAQP RTTY	NA Sprint SSB	Florida QSO Party	CQ WPX CW	ARRL Field Day	RSGB IOTA	WW Digi	SAC CW	CQ WW SSB	CQ WW CW	RAC Winter												
© 2023 Tim Shoppa, N3QE https://Radiosport.World/		30 0000Z	31 2400Z			29 0000Z	30 2359Z			31 1300Z	1 0400Z	28 0000Z	29 2400Z			30 0000Z	1 0000Z						
		CQ WPX SSB								UK/EI DX SSB	CQ WW RTTY												

What Equipment to Use?

You can enter with any station:

- Small or large Antennas (Wires & Beams)
- Power QRP, Low (<100 watts), High (>100 watts)
- Any HF Radio
- CW, SSB, Digital (FT-4/8, RTTY, BPSK, etc.)

KN4DUA (AC6ZM/KR4NFU)

- Icom-7100 | AT-200Pro II
- Surefire® Bandpass Filter
- Cob Web (20 - 6 meters)
- Chelegance Vertical (40)
- 40Ah LiFePO4 battery
- Winkeyer mini



V4/AC6ZM

- Rig: FTdx-3000D
- 2-Element Mosley MP-32N
- 32 Ft Vertical
- Dentron MT-3000A Tuner
- Winkeyer mini



N4SS (KY)

- Multi Single / Low Pwr
- 5 Towers
- 2 Element 40 Beam
- Momo Beams
- Stacked Monobanders
- Tower 1 - EU
- Tower 2 = JA/AS
- Tower 3 = SA
- Tower 4 = VK/ZL/KH
- Tower 5 = 10 meter beam
- Inv L for 160
- Full size Loop for 80



AC6ZM

(Mobile)

- Rig: IC-7100
- Hustler monoband traps
- Tribander 10/15/20/40
- Hustler 80M Resonator
- LDG IT-100 Tuner
- Winkeyer mini



Contest Strategy

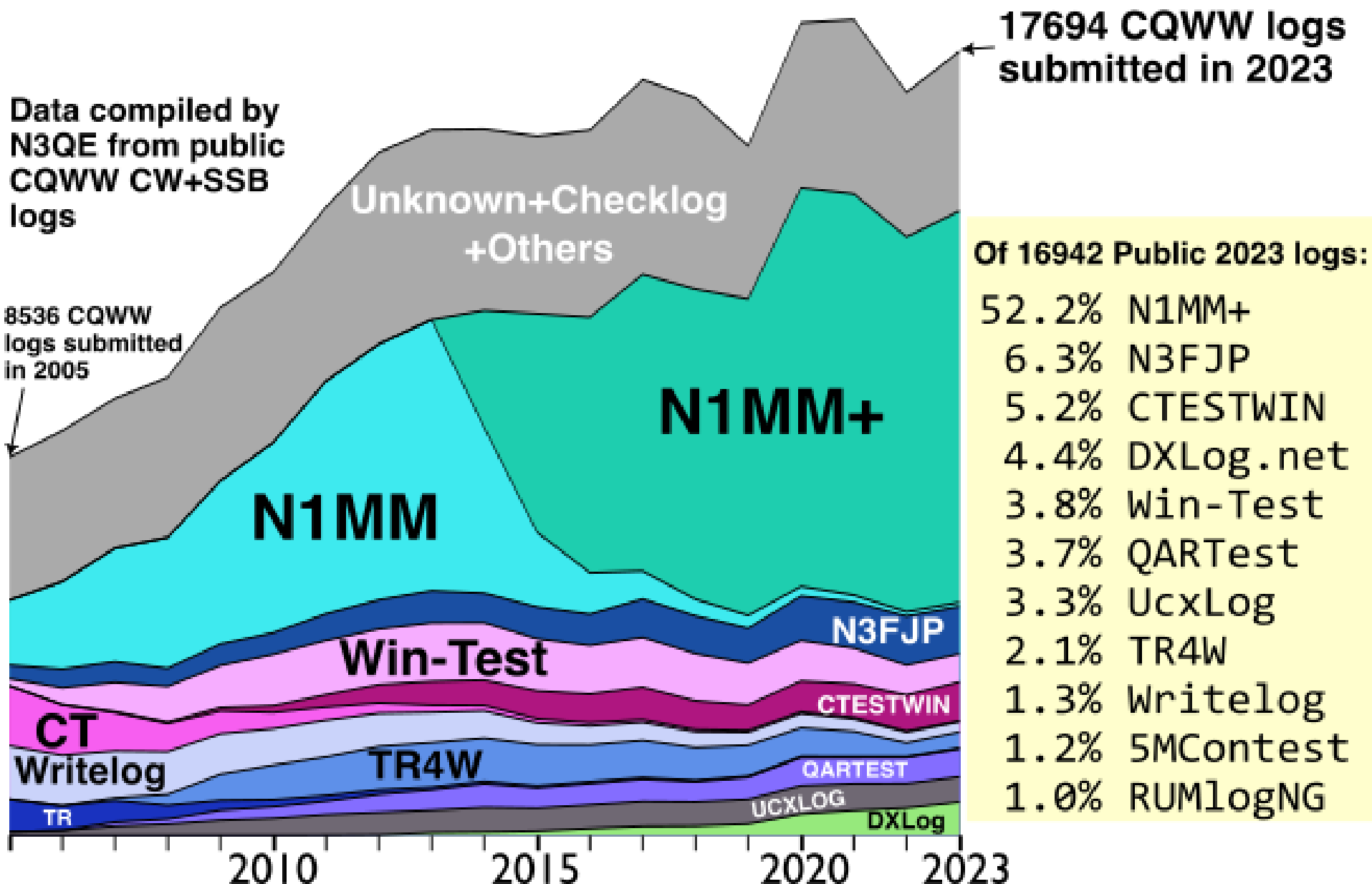
- Search and Pounce (S&P) or Run
- SO2R allows Run-1 and S&P-2
- Logging (N1MM, N3FJP, etc.)
- Decide commitment up front
- Review Rules (exchange format)
- Submit log after contest
 - 3830Scores.com
 - Contest sponsor

Top CQWW contest loggers 2005-2023

<https://Radiosport.World/>

Data compiled by
N3QE from public
CQWW CW+SSB
logs

8536 CQWW
logs submitted
in 2005



Where do I Start?

- State QSO Parties - All domestic
- Digital Contest - RTTY and FT-4/8
- Progress to big ones:
 1. ARRL DX
 2. CQ WW
 3. WAE DX
 4. contestcalendar.com (WA7BNM)

Questions

